



EXPORT STRATEGY

FOR INDIAN EXPORTERS, 2025 started with the looming threat of US tariffs, which materialised at a punitive 50% mid-year, but India closing the year on a high with three trade deals done. While the free trade agreement with EFTA came into effect from October 1, December recorded the signing of the India-Oman trade pact and the completion of talks for the India-New Zealand deal. It is expected that 2026 will also be big for India's trade diversification strategy with the India-EU FTA talks in the final stages and the India-UK agreement to come into effect.



LIQUIDITY BOOST ANNOUNCED BY THE RBI AS IT PLANS TO BUY GOVERNMENT SECURITIES. THE RBI WILL ALSO CONDUCT A \$10-BILLION DOLLAR-RUPEE SWAP AUCTION



THE WAIT CONTINUES...

THE NOIDA INTERNATIONAL Airport has missed several deadlines and the wait continues for operationalisation of Delhi-NCR's second airport in 2026. The closure for commercial flights may get further extended beyond the current deadline of January 31, 2026, with pending infrastructure work and security clearance for CEO Christoph Schnellmann—a Swiss national—as domestic law prohibits a foreign national as head of a greenfield airport. The matter is under the consideration of the union home ministry.

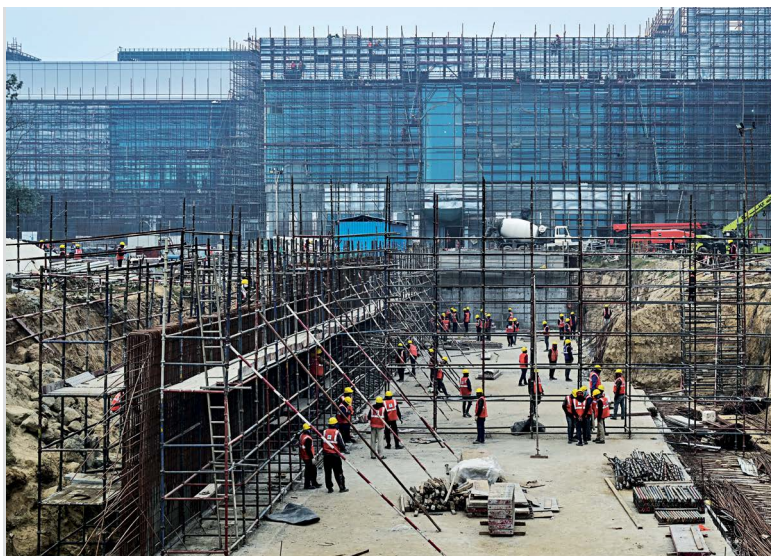


PHOTO BY **HARDIK CHHABRA**

BIG BUYOUTS

IN A YEAR that saw multiple outbound M&A transactions, the \$2.35-billion buyout of US-based Encora by Coforge (earlier known as NIIT Technologies) was not the largest but the biggest ever for India's IT sector. The all-stock deal has not really excited Coforge's shareholders with Encora's modest growth being one of the reasons. At a time, when the overall IT sector in India is going through a challenging phase, how this deal plays out will be interesting.